

RIM acquires Cellmania

BlackBerry developer RIM has acquired Cellmania, an apps storefront, in a move to boost its Blackberry App World

Blu-ray on ASUS laptops

ASUS has announced its N series of laptops N53JN and N73JN having Blu-ray drives and SonicMaster sound technology

iPhone users are luckier?

OkCupid, an American dating site, claims to have generated statistical information that shows iPhone users have twice as much sex as Android users. It claims this after correlating information from over half a million profile images uploaded on the site, and the 11.4 million responses generated by them. Are you confused by the link between someone's sex life and the camera used to take his or her profile picture? It's OK, so are we.

You can read our take on all their stats at <http://bit.ly/bR9ONa>. Basically, OkCupid asked users to choose the more attractive of two randomly paired

profile pictures. Then with EXIF data in hand, they judged which cameras take more attractive pictures, and somehow drew conclusions as to which users get luckier.

It's still pretty unclear to everyone how they arrived at their conclusions, and no one cares – well except the iPhone users who will now start flaunting their devices even more in the hope of getting luckier. What we want to know from you is, living in conservative India, does this mean that all you girls out there are going to start avoiding men with iPhones? What with them being supposedly more promiscuous and all that...**d**

Oracle sues Google for using Java in Android

Everyone knows that Google's Android OS and Dalvik virtual machine are based solidly on the Java platform. Oracle, the owner of the copyright and patent when it bought Sun Microsystems, is accusing Google of violating seven patents, as well as direct duplication of Sun's original Java code.

Oracle's lawsuit is especially interesting, as it says that Google has known about these infringements for the

past five years, and has "knowingly, willingly, and unlawfully" copied, published and distributed its Java-related IP. What makes things even more intriguing is that Google's CEO, Eric Schmidt, was a former leader of the Java team as an employee of Sun. So if Oracle hasn't done anything about this for so long, it stands to reason that relationship between the two companies has broken. It now looks as if the software giant is seeking an injunction to stop the search giant from building or distributing the Android OS. While we are sure the litigation will be lengthy if the issue actually sees the inside of a courtroom, a settlement is much more likely. **d**



Sprint Champs

Sprint sure is on the connectivity war path, offering its second 4G capable smartphone in less than 3 months. The HTC EVO 4G, released on June 4th, received rave reviews but also suffered from some hardware and software bugs. The latest, Epic 4G (also known as Galaxy S Pro) will release on August 31st for \$249.99 (2-year contract plus \$100 mail-in rebate).

The Epic 4G is part of Samsung's Galaxy S family of phones, which recently gave rise to numerous not too dissimilar models in the American market, each for a different carrier, including the Captivate (AT&T), Vibrant (T-Mobile), and

Fascinate (Verizon Wireless – not yet released). While the form of each phone is slightly different, the underlying specifications remain the same, such as the 1GHz Hummingbird processor, the Super AMOLED screen, and the Android 2.1 OS with the latest Samsung TouchWiz 3.0 UI. The Epic 4G is the only one with a hardware QWERTY keypad and an LED flash.

The hardware QWERTY on the Epic 4G is a big plus; though the 8MP camera on the EVO 4G will surely give the HTC device an edge. The EVO 4G is cheaper by \$50, and sports Android 2.2, while the Epic 4G, will still have the older Android 2.1 OS. **d**

Facebook beats Orkut in India

Although Orkut witnessed significant growth in countries such as Brazil and India, recent statistics by major research firm comScore shows that Facebook has taken the throne from Orkut in India. Facebook usage rose by 179 per cent as compared to last year while Orkut did a meagre 16 per cent. **d**

AMD's latest offering

AMD has revealed details about the new 32-nm Bulldozer processor expected in 2011. It's believed to be built ground up – something AMD hasn't done since 2003 when they launched the Athlon 64. AMD also launched the new Bobcat claimed to operate in under a single watt of power with 90 per cent increased performance than current notebook processors. **d**

Open Displeasure

Oracle's recent takeover of Sun got them properties such as OpenSolaris. However, there has been clear displeasure after memos by an Oracle employee stated that they had no interest in further development of the OS. A plan of creating a binary-only version of Solaris Express was put forward. The OpenSolaris Governing Board (OGB) has decided to dissolve and return all control rights to Oracle. Others have expressed unhappiness towards Oracle's handling of OpenSolaris. Adobe's top open source haunch has called Oracle the new enemy of open source, and that Oracle sees open source as a cash cow.

All hope isn't lost though; former employees of Sun and Oracle have started a separate project called Illumos (www.Illumos.org). Illumos is a variant based on OpenSolaris. **d**